

Math 241, F18
Quiz 3

Name: Answer

Instructions: There are totally 2 problems. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer. No calculator is allowed in the quiz.

Problem 1. (5 points) Find an equation of the plane through the points $(0, 1, 2)$, $(2, 0, 1)$, and $(1, 2, 0)$. (Hint: Use the cross product).

$$\text{Take } P = (0, 1, 2), Q = (2, 0, 1), R = (1, 2, 0)$$

$$\vec{PQ} = \langle 2, -1, -1 \rangle, \vec{PR} = \langle 1, 1, -2 \rangle$$

$$\begin{aligned} n = \vec{PQ} \times \vec{PR} &= \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 2 & -1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 & -2 \end{vmatrix} = [(-1)(-2) - (-1)(1)]\mathbf{i} - [2(-2) - (-1)(1)]\mathbf{j} \\ &\quad + [2(1) - (-1)(1)]\mathbf{k} \\ &= 3\mathbf{i} + 3\mathbf{j} + 3\mathbf{k} \end{aligned}$$

Thus the equation of the plane is given by

$$3(x-0) + 3(y-1) + 3(z-2) = 0$$

$$3x + 3y + 3z = 9$$

$$\underline{x + y + z = 3}$$

Problem 2. (5 points) The motion in space of a particle is given by $\mathbf{r}(t) = \langle 2 \cos t, 3 \sin t, 4t \rangle$. Compute the velocity, speed and acceleration of the particle at time $t = \pi/2$.

$$\mathbf{r}(t) = \langle 2 \cos t, 3 \sin t, 4t \rangle$$

$$\Rightarrow \mathbf{v}(t) = \mathbf{r}'(t) = \langle -2 \sin t, 3 \cos t, 4 \rangle$$

$$\mathbf{a}(t) = \mathbf{v}'(t) = \mathbf{r}''(t)$$

$$= \langle -2 \cos t, -3 \sin t, 0 \rangle$$

$$\text{At time } t = \pi/2$$

$$\mathbf{v}\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right) = \langle -2 \sin \frac{\pi}{2}, 3 \cos \frac{\pi}{2}, 4 \rangle = \langle -2, 0, 4 \rangle$$

$$\text{Speed } |\mathbf{v}\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right)| = \sqrt{(-2)^2 + 0^2 + 4^2} = \sqrt{20} = 2\sqrt{5}$$

$$\mathbf{a}\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right) = \langle -2 \cos \frac{\pi}{2}, -3 \sin \frac{\pi}{2}, 0 \rangle = \langle 0, -3, 0 \rangle$$